

Deep Dive: 22. Python Best Practices

Concept Summary

PEP 8 is the official Python style guide. Writing code that works is step one; writing professional code is step two.

Coding Structure

```
snake_case for variables
PascalCase for classes
```

Example Code

```
# BAD CODE:
x = 10
def makeCalc(): pass
class my_class: pass

# GOOD PEP8 CODE:
max_speed = 10
def calculate_total(): pass
class NetworkManager: pass
```

Code Explanation

- Variables and Functions: Should ALWAYS use snake_case (all lowercase words separated by underscores).
- Classes: Should ALWAYS use PascalCase (capitalize the first letter of every word, no underscores).
- Constants: Should use UPPER_SNAKE_CASE.
- These rules ensure your code is readable by any Python developer in the world.

Practice Problems

1. Refactor this bad code to PEP 8: `class dataHandler: def Process_DATA(): userAge = 5`
2. Research how to use the 'pylint' or 'flake8' tools to automatically check your code for PEP 8 compliance.